

ifies that the hash matches the one included with the code. The authenticity of the certificate is checked in the same way, but using the certificate authority's public key, which is included with Windows.

KMCS is enforced by default on Windows Vista for 64-bit systems, and this version of Vista blocks an unsigned application and silently logs the event. The 32-bit version of Vista however, allows unsigned drivers to load as blocking them would break upgraded Windows XP systems. This is also required since certain drivers might only have XP versions which might not come with certificates. However, 32-bit Windows Vista also writes events to the Code Integrity event log when it loads an unsigned driver.

6.4 Windows Defender

To protect your system from malware in the form of spyware, Trojans, rootkits and Web browser exploits, Vista introduced the Windows Defender under Windows XP SP2. While Defender is available as a download for XP, it comes as an inherent part of Windows Vista. Defender is a real-



Let Windows Defender protect your system

time and a background service which starts with Windows and runs continuously in the background. The service constantly scans your files and network activities and alerts you when it stumbles across a suspicious file, or intercepts a malicious program from running or installing on your system. By default, Defender will also update itself every night at around 2 AM in order to be rele-